THE PLAYBOOK

Stop guessing ergonomic risk.

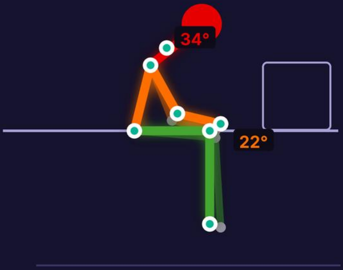
Use this 5-step playbook.

6 rules · 2 min read · save it

START HERE

Wrong assessments lead to missed injuries.

Using RULA for lifting or NIOSH for posture wastes resources. Pick the wrong tool and compliance fails.



→ next: Use RULA for sedentary upper-body tasks

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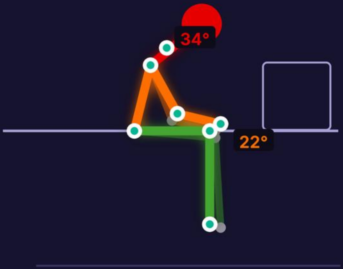
01

STEP 1

Use RULA for sedentary upper-body tasks

Choose RULA if workers are mostly seated at a computer workstation. It scores neck, trunk, and upper limbs.



→ next: Use REBA for dynamic whole-body movement

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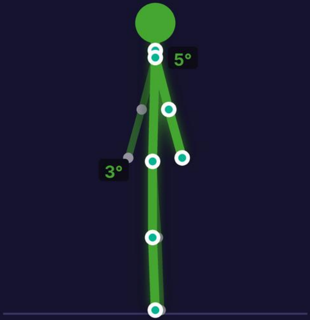
02

STEP 2

Use REBA for dynamic whole-body movement

Select REBA for standing, unpredictable work. It evaluates the whole body including legs and grip.



→ next: Use NIOSH for two-handed lifting tasks

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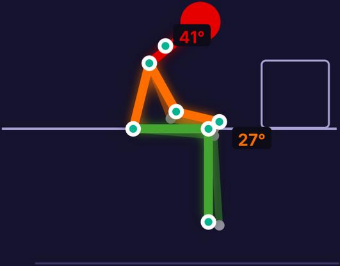
STEP 3

Use NIOSH for two-handed lifting tasks

Apply the Revised NIOSH Lifting Equation for symmetrical two-handed lifting to get the recommended weight limit.



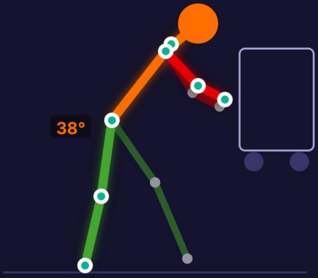
→ next: Use Snook tables for push-pull limits

04

STEP 4

Use Snook tables for push-pull limits

Choose Snook tables for pushing, pulling, and carrying. They set maximum acceptable weights.



→ next: Work-related MSDs dominate injury claims

38%

Work-related MSDs dominate injury claims

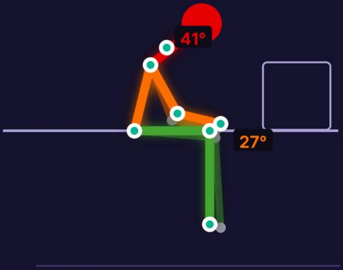
OSHA reports musculoskeletal disorders account for 33-38% of all workplace injuries.

→ next: Redesign the workstation, not the worker

STEP 5

Redesign the workstation, not the worker

Bring high-frequency tasks into the primary reach zone. Keep hands at waist height.



→ next: the recap

The ergonomic selection matrix

- RULA for seated upper-limb tasks.
- REBA for standing dynamic work.
- NIOSH for two-handed lifting limits.

Stop guessing your workplace safety risks.

Save this for your next assessment.